

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCH FELLOW IN ECONOMICS EDUCATION AND INEQUALITY

CORE Econ & Stone Centre Network

Duration: 12 months

Start date: September 2026 (flexible)

Location: Flexible - Stone Centre at UCL or at one of the Stone Centres in Europe, North America, or Asia for candidates with existing residence rights in the country (with extended visits to UCL)

Contract type: Independent contractor if outside of the UK, independent contractor or employment contract if based in the UK

Salary: Competitive, commensurate with location and experience

ABOUT THE POSITION

This is a unique opportunity for an early-career economist passionate about both rigorous research and transformative economics education. You will join CORE Econ - a global initiative revolutionising how economics is taught - while maintaining affiliation with the prestigious Stone Centre network focused on the causes and consequences of wealth inequality.

The position combines (1) time for your own research on inequality, (2) leadership of a major pedagogical innovation project, and (3) collaboration with leading scholars across the Stone Centre network.

Host institution

The host institution will be the Stone Centre at UCL or potentially at one of the following Stone Centres if the candidate has residence rights in the country:

- **Europe:** Paris School of Economics, INSEAD, LMU Munich
 - **North America:** CUNY Graduate Center (short visits due to space constraints), Harvard Kennedy School, UC Berkeley, University of Chicago, University of Michigan, UBC Vancouver, MIT
 - **Asia:** Hong Kong University
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CORE ECON

[CORE Econ](#) has transformed economics education globally, reaching over 520 institutions across 72 countries. Our empirically-grounded, research-led approach uses real-world problems to teach economic principles, integrating cutting-edge research on inequality, climate change, innovation, and policy design. The project is closely linked to the Stone Centre at UCL's mission to make inequality central to economics education.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

You will lead a major initiative with two interconnected objectives:

Objective A: Pedagogical enhancement

Enhance CORE's textbooks (*The Economy*, *Doing Economics*, *Economy, Society, and Public Policy*) to strengthen their appeal and effectiveness in:

- Economics departments teaching undergraduate students
- Public policy schools with heterogeneous student backgrounds

This includes developing:

- AI-tools to assist student learning using CORE textbooks
- New problem sets, case studies, and applications
- Interactive learning modules and digital resources
- Assessment frameworks and instructor support materials
- Content bridging economic theory with policy applications

Objective B: Awareness and adoption

Develop and implement innovative strategies to expand awareness and adoption of research-led, problem-based economics teaching. This includes:

- Creating engagement materials for economics departments and public policy schools
- Building showcases of CORE's research integration (especially inequality research)
- Designing adoption support resources for instructors
- Organising workshops, webinars, or demonstration events
- Leveraging the Stone Centre network for dissemination

Pilot sites

You will work closely with two pilot courses:

1. **UCL - Introduction to Economics (Economics BSc and PPE)**
 - Large cohort (~600+ students)

- Economics undergraduates in Year 1 from BSc Econ and PPE degree programmes
- Focus: rigorous theoretical foundations with empirical applications

2. At a school of public policy - Public Policy Masters Courses

- Heterogeneous student backgrounds (no economics prerequisite required)
- Focus: policy applications, accessibility, diverse learning needs
- Emphasis on real-world problem-solving

Both sites provide opportunities to test new pedagogical tools, gather feedback, and iterate rapidly.

KEY RESPONSIBILITIES

Research (40%)

- Conduct independent research on inequality, wealth concentration, or related topics
- Engage with Stone Centre scholars and seminars at your host institution
- Present research at Stone Centre workshops and conferences
- Prepare papers for publication in leading journals

Pedagogical innovation (50%)

- Lead the enhancement of CORE materials for undergraduate economics and public policy audiences
- Collaborate with pilot sites' instructors to design and test new tools
- Develop AI-tools to assist student learning using CORE textbooks
- Gather and analyse feedback from students and instructors
- Create instructor guides, problem sets, case studies, and multimedia resources
- Develop assessment frameworks aligned with CORE's pedagogical philosophy

Outreach and dissemination (10%)

- Design strategies to raise awareness of CORE's approach among economics departments and policy schools
- Create showcase materials highlighting CORE's integration of cutting-edge inequality research
- Organise workshops, webinars, or events to support adoption
- Leverage the Stone Centre network connections for dissemination
- Produce blogs, videos, or other engagement content

Collaboration

- Work closely with the CORE Econ team (based at UCL)

- Collaborate with faculty at pilot sites
 - Engage with Stone Centre scholars across the network
 - Participate in Stone Centre events and activities
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PERSON SPECIFICATION

Essential criteria

Qualifications and experience:

- PhD in Economics or a closely related field, to be completed by the **end of Summer 2026**
- Dissertation research on inequality, wealth distribution, economic mobility, or related topics
- Strong record of research with potential for publication in top field journals
- Clear commitment to an academic career in economics

Skills and competencies:

- **Passion for economics education:** Demonstrated interest in pedagogy, curriculum development, or teaching innovation
- **Communication excellence:** Ability to explain complex economic concepts to diverse audiences
- **Project management:** Ability to manage multiple workstreams and deliver to deadlines
- **Collaborative approach:** Experience working effectively in teams and across institutions
- **Digital literacy:** Comfort with digital learning tools, online platforms, and multimedia content creation
- **Independence:** Self-motivated and able to work autonomously across different time zones

Personal qualities:

- Entrepreneurial mindset and creative problem-solving
- Commitment to making economics education more accessible and relevant
- Enthusiasm for engaging with practitioners, policymakers, and educators
- Cultural sensitivity and ability to work in a global, diverse environment

Desirable criteria

- Teaching experience in economics or public policy (TA, instructor, or similar)
- Prior involvement with CORE Econ materials (as student, TA, or instructor)
- Experience with economics education research or scholarship of teaching and learning
- Familiarity with public policy education contexts

- Knowledge of or experience with the Stone Centre network
 - Background in applied microeconomics, labour economics, public economics, development, or political economy
 - Experience with curriculum design, learning assessment, or educational technology
 - Track record of public engagement, blogging, or policy communication
 - Multilingual capabilities
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TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Contract type

- Independent contractor if outside of the UK, independent contractor or employment contract if based in the UK
- 12-month contract with possibility of extension subject to funding and performance

Location and travel

- Based at UCL or potentially at another Stone Centre location (subject to visa/work authorisation)
- **Required:** If non-UCL based, minimum 2-4 weeks per year at UCL for in-person collaboration with the CORE team and the pilot site
- **Encouraged:** Visits to other Stone Centres and attendance at Stone Centre events
- Travel expenses for required UCL visits, approved visits to other Stone Centres and conferences are covered

Compensation

- Competitive salary commensurate with location and experience (typically equivalent to postdoctoral rates in the host country)
- Research budget for conferences, data, software, and professional development
- Travel expenses for required visits to pilot sites
- Technology allowance for home office setup

Working arrangements

- Flexible working arrangements as an independent contractor
- Expected to maintain regular communication with the CORE team (online meetings feasible across time zones)
- Participation in Stone Centre activities at the host institution
- Autonomous management of time allocation (40% research / 50% pedagogical innovation / 10% outreach)

Professional development

- Mentorship from CORE Econ leadership and Stone Centre faculty at the host institution
 - Access to Stone Centre network events, seminars, and workshops globally
 - Opportunity to build a profile in the economics education community
 - Support for job market preparation and academic career development
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APPLICATION PROCESS

Application materials

Please submit the following via email to applications@core-econ.org:

1. **Cover letter** (max 2 pages)
 - Explain your interest in this position
 - Describe your passion for economics education
 - Outline your vision for enhancing CORE materials
 - State your connection to any of the Stone Centre location(s)
2. **Curriculum Vitae**
 - Including the dissertation title and abstract
 - List any teaching experience
 - Note any connection to CORE Econ materials or economics education
3. **Research statement** (max 2 pages)
 - Describe your dissertation research
 - Outline your research agenda on inequality/related topics
 - Explain how this aligns with Stone Centre priorities
4. **Teaching and education philosophy statement** (max 2 pages)
 - Describe your approach to economics teaching
 - Share any teaching innovations or experiences
 - Explain your vision for making economics education more effective and accessible
 - Discuss how you would approach the pedagogical innovation objectives
5. **Writing sample**
 - Job market paper or dissertation chapter (preferred)
 - Published paper or working paper (if available)
6. **Three nominated referees (who will be invited to write in support)**
 - At least one who can address your research
 - At least one who can address your teaching/educational interests (if possible)
 - Letters will be requested for the shortlisted candidates

Key dates

- **Application Deadline:** 22 May 2026, 12:59 pm UK time
- **First-round interviews:** 8 - 11 June 2026 (via video)
- **Second-round interviews:** 15 - 18 June 2026 (via video)
- **Offer notification:** 22 June 2026
- **Position start:** September 2026 (flexible)

Interviews

- **First round:** 30-minute video interviews focused on research, teaching philosophy, and project vision
- **Second round:** 60-minute interviews, including presentation of pedagogical innovation ideas

Selection criteria

Applications will be assessed on:

- Quality and relevance of research (35%)
 - Passion for and vision for economics education (30%)
 - Project management and communication skills (20%)
 - Fit with CORE Econ and Stone Centre missions (15%)
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FURTHER INFORMATION

About CORE Econ

Visit www.core-econ.org to explore our textbooks, see adoption statistics, and read testimonials from instructors and students worldwide.

About the Stone Centre at UCL

Visit www.stone-econ.org to learn about research, events, and the global Stone Centre network.

Informal inquiries

For informal inquiries about the position, contact:

- Luka Crnjakovic, CORE and Stone Centre at UCL Head of Operations:
luka@core-econ.org

For questions about specific Stone Centre host locations, we can facilitate connections with directors at the location.

Equal opportunities

We welcome applications from candidates of all backgrounds. CORE Econ and Stone Centre network are committed to diversity, equity, and inclusion in economics research and education. We particularly encourage applications from women, underrepresented minorities, and candidates from diverse national and cultural backgrounds.

Visa and work authorization

- Candidates may need to arrange their own visa/work authorization depending on the host country
 - We will provide support letters and documentation as needed
 - Independent contractor status may affect visa options - we encourage early consultation with immigration advisors
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WHY THIS POSITION?

This role offers a unique combination:

- ✓ **Research freedom** with 40% time for your own inequality research
- ✓ **Leadership opportunity** on a high-impact global education project
- ✓ **Network access** to 13 leading institutions in the Stone Centre network
- ✓ **Career development** combining research, teaching, and education scholarship
- ✓ **Flexibility** in your geographic location depending on your visa / residency status
- ✓ **Impact** on how thousands of students learn economics worldwide
- ✓ **Visibility** in both inequality research and economics education communities

This position is ideal for scholars who want to combine rigorous research with transformative education work, positioning you uniquely for academic careers that value both research excellence and pedagogical innovation.

Questions: luka@core-econ.org

Send application to: applications@core-econ.org

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